

HOW IT WORKS

When Edison spoke into the horn, the pressure of his voice caused the needle to scratch indentations into the tinfoil-coated cylinder as it rotated. When the needle was moved over the indentations it had scratched into the foil, it played back the sound of Edison's voice through the horn, which magnified the sound.



How it changed the world

It's hard to imagine life without a soundtrack of your favorite songs, but before the phonograph, you had to make your own music or go to concerts to hear them. Recorded sound meant that at last everyone could listen to the world's greatest music in their homes.

Into the groove

As time passed, **FURTHER IMPROVEMENTS** were made to both the records and the players. The

grooves on records became thinner, so more sound could fit on each disc. **Loudspeakers**

replaced the horns of the early phonographs to amplify the sound. With

these improvements, records were finally sounding great, and people started collecting music from their **favorite musicians**.

Incredible Edison

Although he ended up with more than a **thousand inventions** to his name, Edison considered the phonograph to be his favorite invention.

He set up his own record label, **EDISON RECORDS**, to publish new recordings—first on cylinders, and later on discs. He continually improved the phonograph **right up until his death** in 1931.

By the way...

I was very hard of hearing, which helped me concentrate—maybe that's why I never invented a hearing aid!

COMPACT DISCS were invented in 1965 but didn't become popular until they were **MASS-PRODUCED** in the 1980s.



MP3 PLAYERS were invented in the late 1990s, making it possible to take your **ENTIRE MUSIC COLLECTION** with you wherever you go.